TECH TEAM BRAVO
– INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY –

OFFICE MANAGER COPY

# New Hire and Departing Staff IT Checklist

Give new staff the right access on day one, and take every bit of it back on their last day. Print it, fill in page 2, and use it every time someone joins or leaves the practice.

**THE ONE RULE** — **Access ends the day the job ends. Turn it off before or as they walk out, not next week.**

START HERE

## When someone joins or leaves

1. **Tell IT in writing first.** Send the name, role, start or last day, and who approved it.
2. **Give only what the role needs.** A front desk login does not need billing or admin rights.
3. **One person, one login.** No shared passwords for the EHR, email or the scheduling system.
4. **On the last day, list every system** they used: EHR, email, portals, phones, building codes and vendor sites.
5. **Collect and log the equipment.** Laptops, phones, badges, keys and tokens, with the date returned.

DO NOT

## Common mistakes

- ✕ Waiting a week to turn off a login "in case they need something"
- ✕ Letting a new hire use someone else's login until theirs is ready
- ✕ Forgetting vendor sites: labs, clearinghouses, payer portals
- ✕ Leaving a departed person's email forwarding to a personal address
- ✕ Keeping the same door code or alarm code after someone leaves
- ✕ Handing a used laptop to a new hire without having IT reset it
- ✕ Skipping the checklist for part-time, temp or per diem staff

## If this happens, do this

### Someone leaves on bad terms or without notice

Firings, walkouts and tense resignations. Act the same day, ideally before the conversation ends.

- **Call IT now** and have every login disabled during or right after the meeting
- Change shared codes: door, alarm, voicemail and Wi-Fi
- Ask for all devices, badges and keys before they leave
- **Have IT check recent activity** for downloads, deletes or new forwarding rules
- Tell your privacy officer if anything looks off
- Write down what was done, when and by whom on page 2

### A new hire starts Monday

Plan it the week before, not that morning.

- Send IT the role and start date
- Have their own logins ready on day one
- Cover privacy and phishing basics in week one

### Someone changes roles

A move from front desk to billing, or a promotion.

- Add the new access the role needs
- Remove the old access they no longer need
- Note the change on page 2

### A temp or per diem worker

Short assignments are easy to forget.

- Set an end date on their accounts up front
- Use their own login, never a shared one
- Check it was turned off on the end date

### A login was left on by mistake

You find an old account still active.

- Have IT disable it right away
- Ask IT to check whether it was used
- Tell your privacy officer and log it

# Fill this in before you need it

When someone leaves in a hurry, nobody remembers every system. List them here once, review the list every January, and update it whenever you add a system or a vendor.

## Systems to turn on and off

| SYSTEM | WHO CAN CHANGE IT | ADMIN CONTACT OR NOTES |
|---|---|---|
| **IT support**<br>Call first for any join, leave or role change | | **TTB clients: (855) 488-2832, press 1** |
| **EHR and practice management**<br>Every user account and role | | |
| **Email and shared mailboxes**<br>Microsoft 365 or Google | | |
| **Phones and voicemail**<br>Extensions, voicemail PINs, apps | | |
| **Payer and clearinghouse portals** | | |
| **Lab, imaging and pharmacy portals** | | |
| **Building access and alarm**<br>Door codes, alarm codes, badges | | |
| **Practice Wi-Fi**<br>Change the staff password when someone leaves | | |
| **Privacy officer**<br>Reports anything that looks off | | |

DAY ONE

### New hire checklist

- ☐ Own login for the EHR, email and phones
- ☐ Access set to the role, nothing extra
- ☐ Multi-factor sign-in turned on
- ☐ Computer set up or reset by IT
- ☐ Privacy and phishing basics covered
- ☐ Privacy and computer use policies signed

LAST DAY

### Departing staff checklist

- ☐ Every login disabled, vendor sites too
- ☐ Forwarding to personal email removed
- ☐ Shared codes changed: door, alarm, Wi-Fi
- ☐ Devices, badges, keys and tokens returned
- ☐ Mailbox and files handed to a manager
- ☐ Changes logged below with date and initials

## Access change log

| DATE | STAFF MEMBER | JOINED, LEFT OR NEW ROLE | SYSTEMS TURNED ON OR OFF | DONE BY |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | |
| | | | | |
| | | | | |

**Why this matters.** A pain management practice with 126 employees was hit with a $1.19 million HIPAA penalty after a former contractor kept access to its records system. The work ended in August 2018, but the access stayed on, and it was used three times to reach about 34,310 patients' records before it was shut off in February 2019. HIPAA expects written steps to end access when someone leaves (45 CFR 164.308(a)(3)(ii)(C)). General guidance; adapt it to your practice.

Source: HHS Office for Civil Rights, Gulf Coast Pain Consultants Notice of Proposed Determination, 2024.

FREE FOR LONG ISLAND PRACTICES

### Would a former employee still get in?

Book a free 15-minute IT Risk Check. No sales pitch, and you get a one-page summary of what to fix first.

**techteambravo.com/book**